

ID: SOMA-M-P05

Title: Brushing Teeth

Duration: 9m 59s (739 words)

Script Content:

[Practice]

When you're ready, let's begin this practice.

Today, you have an opportunity to cultivate awareness about the whole experience of brushing your teeth. Especially bringing attention to the five senses as you do so: seeing, touching, hearing, tasting, and smelling. Allow this audio to play in the background and follow the guidance as best you can. At any time, feel free to adapt the instructions to support the natural way you brush your teeth.

So, let's practice.

You could start by bringing intentional awareness to what happens right before you engage in the activity. For example, how you enter the space where your toothbrush is. You can start by simply noticing how you are arriving here. You may observe whether you feel rushed, fairly calm, or tired, and acknowledge your state in this moment without judging it.

And what about the space? Did you turn on the light with awareness or on autopilot? What might it be like to arrive at this familiar space with a fresh, intentional curiosity? As if you are here for the first time.

[Short Pause] (10s - Room awareness)

What colors, shapes, and objects are here? And do any stand out? What else is here to notice? Birdsong or a slight breeze coming through a window? The subtle smell of a bar of soap or any grooming products?

[Short Pause] (10s - Sensory check)

And now, as you are about to reach for your toothbrush, an invitation to notice how you do that. What's involved in this routine movement? Perhaps a tendency to rush? Or can you perhaps notice any sensations in your arm and hand?

And what about the color, texture, and flexibility of the toothbrush? What's it like to observe and handle an object you have seen so many times before? Can you perhaps notice any new detail? Noticing what it's like to engage with something simple in this new way.

[Short Pause] (10s - Handling the brush)

And now, an invitation to pay kindly attention to how you are preparing the toothbrush and toothpaste. Which hand is holding what? What's it like to squeeze the tube? How much toothpaste do you apply? And was that your choice or perhaps more of an automaticity?

[Short Pause] (10s - Preparation)

And then, noticing what's involved in the process of bringing the toothbrush to your mouth. Did you perhaps speed up? How did your arm know where your mouth is?

And now, beginning to brush the teeth. Noticing where in the mouth you started.

What is the toothpaste like? Is the texture smooth or somewhat gritty? What about the temperature, the taste? Perhaps a sense of minty-ness or sweetness.

Or perhaps noticing if it's more challenging to observe these details, which is your valid experience of this activity. You may notice how the toothpaste begins to foam inside your mouth. If it feels OK to do so, now staying with the practice of noticing for a few moments as you brush.

[Long Pause] (25s - Active brushing)

There may be thoughts arising in the mind. Or perhaps your attention is being pulled away by sounds or events happening around you. This is all normal and not a mistake. If you get distracted, simply notice it. Then, bring your attention back to brushing your teeth.

With curiosity, paying attention to the movements of your arm and hand as you brush the teeth.

[Short Pause] (10s - Motor awareness)

How is the brush coming in contact with the inside of the mouth? How do the bristles feel against the teeth and the gums? Not over-doing anything, but brushing in your usual way, in a way that is best for you.

[Short Pause] (10s - Tactile focus)

You might even bring awareness to the sounds of brushing.

[Short Pause] (10s - Auditory focus)

How do you "know" or sense that the teeth are now clean enough, and you are ready to rinse and gargle?

And now when you're ready, tuning in to the sound of the tap water running. Inviting curiosity to the temperature of the water with your hand and fingers. Is there coolness? Is there warmth?

As you rinse and gargle, turning your attention inwards, noticing the sounds and sensations of gargling. What is this like?

[Short Pause] (10s - Rinsing)

Noticing how many times you rinse the mouth.

And when the teeth feel clean or you feel ready to stop, also maintaining your awareness on the way you are bringing this activity to an end. Are you perhaps speeding up? Using these final moments of the practice to notice what ending this activity feels like.

[Pause] (20s - Final integration)

Feel free to take a slow deep breath and allow this practice to come to a close.

Thank you for your practice.

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